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Using Generative AI Tools at LSE: guidance for ST498 – CAPSTONE PROJECTS

Generative AI tools can analyse data, and create writing, computer code, and/or images using minimal human prompting. Over the last year, generative AI tools have proliferated and are now embedded in most everyday software and services.

As a student, it's important that you understand how you can use Generative AI in your assessments so that you can do your best in your studies.

As a pedagogically diverse School with different disciplines, there is no one approach to the use of generative AI across LSE. Instead, there are three positions to know about:

- Position 1: No authorised use of generative AI in assessment.
- Position 2: Limited authorised use of generative AI in assessment
- Position 3: Full authorised use of generative AI in assessment.

In this course, we follow:

Position 3 – Full authorised use of generative AI in assessment

This means that **generative AI can be used throughout the learning and assessment process in this course.**

Summative assessments on ST498 comprise partial presentations of the progress of your project, a draft report, and the final group and individual reports. Formative assessments comprise any sort of interactions with your project supervisor (LSE faculty) and industry or academic partner where you present technical questions and/or ask for guidance.

Generative AI tools can be a helpful resource for identifying and summarising literature sources, drafting your reports, proofreading any piece of text, and helping with your code and data analysis. These tools can also be used as “targeted models” in the context of your project, thus being part of the outputs generated by your research. Make sure to **use such tools responsibly to not harm your learning and ensure you are developing and improving your analytical (data science) skills as expected.**

We recommend that you talk to your project supervisor and academic or industry partner about the intended use of generative AI tools in your capstone project.

The degree to which you may use these tools in ST498, as well as which assessments are outlined below:

- You are encouraged to make use of technology, including generative AI tools, to contribute to your understanding of any materials related to the scope of your project. This includes reference literature, technical documents, and example code.
- You may use generative AI tools in this course as learning aids or to help produce formative and summative deliverables. However, students are ultimately accountable

for the work they submit. Do not submit work that is not yours and/or entirely generated by AI tools.

- You may choose to use generative AI tools as you work through the deliverables in this course. This use must be documented in an appendix for each deliverable. The documentation should include: (i) what tool(s) were used, (ii) any content produced by an AI tool, (iii) the prompts used to generate the content, and **(most importantly)** (iv) how the results from the AI were incorporated into your submitted work.
- **(extremely important)** Regardless of whether you use generative AI tools or not, any submitted deliverable (presentations and reports) must be self-contained and clearly show all outputs and findings. Do not supplement your code or report with chat logs or part of them. Markers will not look at multiple files to assess your work.
- You must submit your appendix as a PDF or Word document and ensure that links to any chat logs are fully accessible.
- In all submissions where you use generative AI, you must [cite its usage](#). Failing to cite the use of generative AI is a form of [academic misconduct](#). LSE's library provides [guidance on the four main citation styles](#) used at LSE (APA, Chicago, Harvard, and OSCOLA) and recommends students use [Cite Them Right](#).

Generative AI at LSE: resources and tools

As a student at LSE, you have access to Microsoft's generative AI tool, Copilot, for free. Please ensure you understand how to use Copilot effectively and responsibly in your studies, [using our guidance](#).

To help you further develop your understanding, you can attend a [Copilot workshop](#) run by the Digital Skills Lab and enrol on the [Moodle course on developing your AI literacy](#).